

# Top federal grant opportunities for NC DHHS

For the NC DHHS federal-grants coordinator · grants as of 30 Sep 2026 (Grants.gov export pulled 18 Aug 2026) · NC DHHS award history from USAspending.gov, FY2022–FY2025

**Our 5 match criteria:** (1) DHHS can apply, as lead or partner (a gate) · (2) supports a goal in the DHHS 2023–2025 Strategic Plan · (3) a DHHS division already does this work · (4) realistic time to apply · (5) award worth the effort.

**Score (0–100), a published formula, not AI:** strategic fit 30% · DHHS can run it 25% · award size 15% · deadline 15% · eligibility certainty 15%. Rationales are written by AI (DeepSeek V4 Pro) and backed by verified quotes from each grant; scores are computed in Python.

## Apply now: top 10 open opportunities

| # | Grant                                                                                                                | Score | Why it fits (one line)                                                                                                                                                                   | Check against our 5 criteria                                                                                                                                                                                           | NC DHHS won FY22–25 |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 1 | Title X Family Planning Services Grants                                                                              | 98    | Strong fit: Title X directly funds family planning and preconception services under DPH, advancing G2.O4 reproductive and maternal health work.                                          | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Child and Family Well-Being (10/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 9/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-01-11 (103 days)<br>5 Award: \$22.0M, cost share: no   | \$14.7M             |
| 2 | Public Health Crisis Response Cooperative Agreement                                                                  | 83    | Aligns with public health workforce surge staffing and DPH preparedness role; only creates an unfunded roster until CDC activates an emergency.                                          | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Strong and Inclusive Workforce (6/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 9/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-02-11 (134 days)<br>5 Award: \$5.0M, cost share: no  | none on record      |
| 3 | Home Study and Post-Release Services for Unaccompanied Alien Children                                                | 81    | Fits G2.O2 child safety and permanency and state child welfare expertise in DSS, but serves a federal immigration-specific population with high ORR compliance demands.                  | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Child and Family Well-Being (7/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Social Services (fit 6/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-10-01 (366 days)<br>5 Award: \$100.0M, cost share: no | none on record      |
| 4 | Emerging Infections Network - Research for Preventing, Detecting, and Managing Travel-associated Infectious Diseases | 77    | Strong fit for DPH disease surveillance and preparedness; CDC travel-focused sentinel network advances data-driven decision-making, though it is not squarely in NCDHHS strategic goals. | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (5/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 9/10)<br>4 Timing: 2026-11-05 (36 days)<br>5 Award: \$6.0M, cost share: no           | none on record      |
| 5 | NARMS Cooperative Agreement Program to Strengthen Antibiotic Resistance Surveillance in Retail Food Specimens        | 70    | Funds antibiotic resistance surveillance in retail food; fits DPH lab and epidemiology role but is narrow and not a named NCDHHS objective.                                              | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (6/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 8/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-04-01 (183 days)<br>5 Award: \$200K, cost share: no          | none on record      |

| #  | Grant                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Score | Why it fits (one line)                                                                                                                                                                                         | Check against our 5 criteria                                                                                                                                                                                              | NC DHHS won FY22–25 |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 6  | Laboratory Flexible Funding Model (LFFM)                                                                                                                                                                                    | 68    | This FDA cooperative agreement funds state food testing laboratory capacity which fits DPH's public health laboratory and environmental health role though it is not tied to named NCDHHS strategic objective. | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: none matched (3/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 8/10)<br>4 Timing: 2028-01-11 (468 days)<br>5 Award: \$1.5M, cost share: no                       | none on record      |
| 7  | US Travelers Health Research, Surveillance, Communication, and Outreach Network                                                                                                                                             | 66    | The CDC travel health surveillance network is a moderate fit for DPH infectious disease work but only indirectly supports NCDHHS data infrastructure and health access goals.                                  | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (5/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 7/10)<br>4 Timing: 2026-11-05 (36 days)<br>5 Award: \$1.0M, cost share: no              | none on record      |
| 8  | Institute of Education Sciences (IES): National Center for Special Education Research (NCSE): Using Longitudinal Data to Support State Education Policymaking in Special Education, Assistance Listing Number (ALN) 84.324S | 57    | Special education SLDS work is primarily DPI/SEA; NCDHHS fits only through early intervention and lacks the research/data-system role, so it is not a priority.                                                | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (7/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Child and Family Well-Being (fit 5/10)<br>4 Timing: 2026-10-01 (1 days)<br>5 Award: \$1.2M, cost share: no | none on record      |
| 9  | Innovative Traffic Safety Enforcement (ITSE) Grant Program                                                                                                                                                                  | 48    | Traffic safety enforcement falls under law enforcement/DOT, not NCDHHS health and human services; no division has authority or capacity to run it.                                                             | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: none matched (0/10)<br>3 Owner: none (fit 1/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-09-01 (336 days)<br>5 Award: \$20.0M, cost share: no                                           | none on record      |
| 10 | Authority to Accept Unsolicited Proposals for Research Partnerships Notice of Intent (NOI)                                                                                                                                  | 47    | HUD housing-policy research does not fund NCDHHS health/human services priorities and requires a 50% match; low fit for any division.                                                                          | 1 Eligibility: eligible but atypical (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (3/10)<br>3 Owner: none (fit 2/10)<br>4 Timing: 2027-06-09 (252 days)<br>5 Award: \$250K, cost share: yes                         | none on record      |

## Prepare now: top 5 forecast opportunities (announced, not yet open)

| # | Grant                                                                                                                                                    | Score | Why it fits (one line)                                                                                                                                                                              | Check against our 5 criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NC DHHS won FY22-25 |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 1 | HIV Care Grant Program - Part B States/Territories Formula and AIDS Drug Assistance Program Formula and AIDS Drug Assistance Program Supplemental Awards | 96    | Core DPH work: Ryan White HIV care and AIDS Drug Assistance Program funding advances G1 health access for low-income North Carolinians with HIV.                                                    | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Health Access (9/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 10/10)<br>4 Timing: forecast close 2026-10-30 - may already be open, check Grants.gov now<br>5 Award: \$24.8M, cost share: no                                  | \$187.6M            |
| 2 | Maternal, Infant, and Early Childhood Home Visiting Program (MIECHV)                                                                                     | 96    | MIECHV directly funds home visiting that improves maternal and child health and birth outcomes; NCDHHS's Child and Family Well-Being division already runs home visiting, making this a strong fit. | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Child and Family Well-Being (9/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Child and Family Well-Being (fit 10/10)<br>4 Timing: forecast close 2027-03-18<br>5 Award: \$11.6M, cost share: yes                                                 | \$21.1M             |
| 3 | Strengthening Services to Prevent the Infectious Disease Consequences of Drug Use                                                                        | 94    | Directly funds infectious disease testing and harm reduction for people who use drugs, fitting DPH disease prevention and G3.O4 substance use crisis priorities.                                    | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Behavioral Health and Resilience (9/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 9/10)<br>4 Timing: forecast close 2027-05-24<br>5 Award: \$41.2M, cost share: no                                                            | none on record      |
| 4 | Preschool Development Grant Birth Through Five (PDG B-5) SMART Grant                                                                                     | 94    | One-year federal grant would fund early childhood data and technology infrastructure, directly supporting G5.O1 and fitting DCDEE's early learning data role.                                       | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Operational Excellence (9/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Child Development and Early Education (fit 9/10)<br>4 Timing: forecast close 2026-11-17 - may already be open, check Grants.gov now<br>5 Award: \$15.0M, cost share: yes | \$36.3M             |
| 5 | National HIV Behavioral Surveillance                                                                                                                     | 93    | Funds HIV behavioral surveillance to track disparities and guide prevention, directly fitting DPH's existing disease surveillance and epidemiology role.                                            | 1 Eligibility: DHHS can lead (quote verified)<br>2 Goal: Health Access (9/10)<br>3 Owner: Division of Public Health (fit 10/10)<br>4 Timing: forecast close 2026-09-01 - date passed, check if posted<br>5 Award: \$3.7M, cost share: no                                                | \$30.2M             |

Full method, code and every number: [github.com/YaolaP4/Solveathon-Project](https://github.com/YaolaP4/Solveathon-Project) (submission/README.md). Grant names link to the Grants.gov listing.